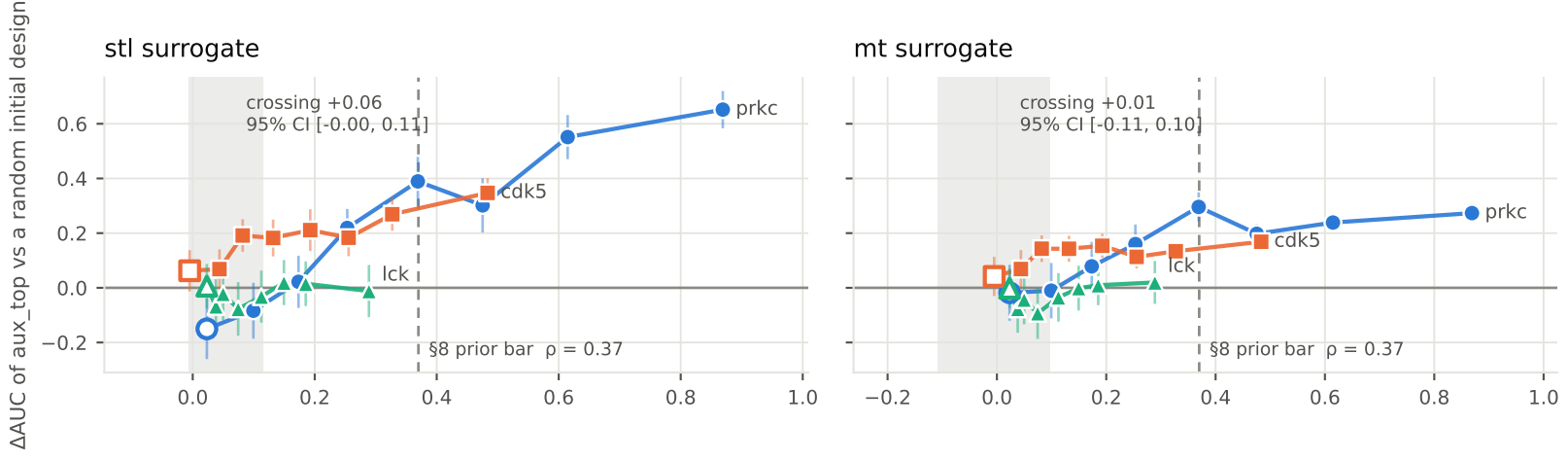
Degrading a relative's data walks the gain to zero — and the crossing is inside the data

A pure-noise auxiliary (hollow marker) buys nothing, which is what makes the rest of the curve readable.